



MindShift

PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES



A MINDSHIFT PSYCHOLOGICAL SERVICES GUIDE

The Anxiety & Stress Tool Kit

Practical, evidence-based tools to calm your body and mind, right when you need them.

Southern California • Individual, Couples & Family Psychotherapy
www.mindshiftwellnesscenter.com • (714) 584-9700





WELCOME

Your Nervous System Isn't Broken

Anxiety is your body's ancient alarm system — designed to protect you, not punish you. When it fires too often or too loudly, it can feel like it's running the show. This kit gathers tools from Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT), and Acceptance & Commitment Therapy (ACT) so you have real, research-backed options for the moment anxiety shows up.

How to use this guide

You don't need to use every tool. Read through once, then circle the two or three that feel most doable. Practice them when you're calm, so they're easier to reach for when you're not.

A QUICK REFRAME

Anxiety is a wave, not a wall. Every wave you've ever felt has eventually crested and passed — including this one.

NOTES & REFLECTION

Where do you usually feel anxiety first in your body? What word would you use to describe it today?

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Ground Your Body First

TOOL THREE & FOUR

Work With Your Thoughts and Your Body

The CBT Thought Record: Catch, Check, Change

1. Catch the thought. What exactly ran through your mind right before the anxiety spiked?
2. Check the evidence. What actually supports this thought? What challenges it?
3. Change the frame. What's a more balanced, realistic thought you could hold instead?

DBT's TIPP for Intense Moments

- Temperature: splash cold water on your face or hold an ice pack for 30 seconds.
- Intense exercise: a brisk walk or 20 jumping jacks to burn off adrenaline.
- Paced breathing: exhale longer than you inhale.
- Paired muscle relaxation: tense a muscle group for 5 seconds, then release.

NOTES & REFLECTION

Write a recent anxious thought below, then try reframing it into something more balanced.

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Make Room With ACT

- Name it: "I'm noticing anxiety showing up right now."
- Make room: let the sensation exist in your body without pushing it away.
- Choose your move: ask, "What's one value-aligned step I can still take?"

"I can feel anxious and still take this next step." Anxiety and courage are allowed to be in the room together.

What's one value-aligned action anxiety has been getting in the way of lately?

YOUR TOOLKIT

Build Your Personal Anxiety Plan

Fill this in now, while you're calm, so it's ready when you need it.

My top 3 early warning signs that anxiety is building are:

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My go-to grounding tool is:

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A thought that tends to fuel my anxiety, and a more balanced version of it:

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One person I can reach out to when I need support:

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One value-aligned action I want anxiety to stop stopping me from doing:

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BEFORE YOU GO

You Don't Have to Carry This Alone

Reaching for a resource like this one is already an act of self-care. If anything here resonated, know that our licensed California clinicians are ready to help you go deeper — with real support, tailored to your story, at a pace that feels right for you.

Rachael Morua, LMFT, CST

License #LMFT106917 • Founder, MindShift Psychological Services
On behalf of the licensed clinicians of the MindShift care team

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IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS

Call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911. You deserve support right now.



Visit Our Website



Contact Us to Get Started

